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Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities

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List of issues in relation to the initial report of Gabon

Addendum

Replies of Gabon to the list of issues*

[Date received: 30 July 2015]

A. Purpose and general obligations (arts. 1-4)

Definitions (art. 2)

1. **Reasonable accommodation**: this obligation certainly exists in Gabon, in particular in respect of persons with disabilities, both in the Constitution of Gabon and in the Labour Code, where the right to equality is mentioned. The Government is working to make the changes necessary to enable persons with disabilities to enjoy their rights and fundamental freedoms on an equal basis with others. In this regard, for example, in both the public and private sectors, persons with disabilities who use wheelchairs are provided with workstations adapted to their needs. Efforts are also being made to provide persons with disabilities with work environments that are better suited to their needs.

2. **Universal design**: this concern is evident in the public policies of Gabon. The Government is working to provide persons with and without disabilities with goods, equipment, programmes and services that can be used by anyone. Although still tentative, measures are being taken — to ensure greater accessibility, for example. The Government is committed to making public spaces more accessible to persons with disabilities. Efforts are being made in the architectural sphere and in televisual communications, where the aim is to provide very simple information. The Government's objective is to help persons with physical, sensory or intellectual disabilities remain independent and at the same time to avoid stigmatizing them.

* The present document is being issued without formal editing.

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General obligations (art. 4)

3. **Consultation with and active participation by persons with disabilities**: the Ministry of Social Affairs relies on consultation and participation mechanisms to ensure that persons with disabilities, their legal representatives and the leaders of organizations of persons with disabilities are consulted whenever a public policy may affect them, directly or indirectly. Meetings, in the form of conferences, are often held. Day-care centres, primary schools, middle schools and high schools, as well as universities, make sure they comply with an accessibility policy in order to include young people with disabilities.[1] In addition, the Labour Code prohibits discrimination against workers in hiring and promotion.[2] Regarding celebrations, a National Day for Persons with Disabilities has been proclaimed. Social assistance and health insurance also cover persons with disabilities.

4. Under the national legislation related to the Convention, the State allocates an annual budget to the Ministry of Social Affairs. In addition to the Civil Code, the Criminal Code and the Labour Code, a dozen acts, one ordinance, eight or so decrees, three orders and two decisions are worth noting. The acts are:

- Act No. 16/66 on compulsory primary education;
- Act No. 19/95 of 13 February 1996 on the organization of social welfare for persons with disabilities;
- Act No. 7/96 of 12 March 1996 on political elections, which does not discriminate, in this regard;
- Act No. 5/98 of 5 March 1998 on the status of refugees in Gabon;
- Act No. 87/98 of 20 July 1999 on the Nationality Code, which promotes the interests of women and children;
- Acts Nos. 9/89 and 10/99 on pretrial detention and on compensation for wrongful pretrial detention;
- Act No. 9/2004 of 21 September 2005 on combating and preventing child trafficking in Gabon;
- Act No. 19/2005 of 3 January 2006 on the establishment and organization of the National Human Rights Commission.

5. The ordinance is Ordinance No. 59/79 of 1 October 1976 on child protection, which prohibits persons less than 21 years of age from going out into public places after 9 p.m.

6. The decrees are:

- Decree No. 01389/PR/MASPF of 2 November 1982 proclaiming a National Day for Persons with Disabilities;
- Decree No. 000152/PR/MNASBE of 4 February 2002 on the responsibilities, structure and operation of the National Committee for the Integration of Persons with Disabilities;

[1] Article 180 of the Labour Code: “To the extent possible, and taking account of particular disabilities, employers of persons with disabilities must create easy access for workers at their place of employment and a suitable work environment, in order to make working as easy for persons with disabilities as for persons without.”

[2] Article 179 of the Labour Code: “Given equal qualifications, any discrimination on grounds of physical or mental disability on recruitment, during the period of employment or at the end of the contract, is strictly prohibited.”

- Decree No. 00243/PR/MASSNBE of 12 April 2002 introducing the free distribution of school textbooks;
- Decree No. 00102/PR/MISPD of 17 October 2002 establishing the Department of Prison Health and the Department of Social Affairs, which is responsible for social issues;
- Decree No. 000024/PR/MTE of 6 January 2006 regulating checks, investigations and searches for the purposes of preventing and combating child trafficking in Gabon;
- Decree No. 000873/PR/MFPEPF of 17 November 2006 on the establishment, role and functioning of a National Observatory for Children's Rights;
- Decree No. 303/PR/MCAEPRDH of 31 March 2008 establishing the procedures for appointment of members of the National Commission on Human Rights;
- Decree No. 103/PR/MDHLCCLCI of 15 January 2007 establishing National Human Rights Day.

7. The orders are:

- Order No. 001/PM/MDCPRPE/AS of 12 December 1972 establishing a court welfare office in Libreville;
- Order No. 0012/MASSBE/DGAS of 5 November 1985 establishing a school for hearing-impaired children;
- Order No. 1145/PM/PAECF of 30 July 2000 establishing an identity card for refugees and regulating its issuance and renewal.

8. The following two decisions have also been made:

- Decision No. 055/MASSNCRS/SG/DAS/SASS of 5 April 1992 on the establishment of an ad hoc commission on placements for abandoned children;
- Decision No. 000001/PM/MESI/PDM of 3 June 2006 establishing the procedure for the care and repatriation of trafficked children in the province of Ogooué-Maritime.

9. Finally, for the sake of completeness, the following instruments must be taken into account:

- The bill on mental health in Gabon;
- The Civil Code;
- The Criminal Code;
- The Labour Code.

B. Specific rights

Equality and non-discrimination (art. 5)

10. There is not, it must be said, a specific law prohibiting discrimination against persons with disabilities. However, in addition to the international instruments ratified by Gabon — six international conventions and two optional protocols — there is a set of legal instruments that gives them the right to the support of the entire national community, such as the following:

- Act No. 19/95 provides social protection to persons with disabilities;

- The Act regulates the civil service guarantees them equal pay; Ordinance No. 0022/PR/2007 establishes the system of compulsory health insurance and social welfare, including for persons with disabilities;
- The system of family benefits for low-income Gabonese includes persons with disabilities, through Ordinance No. 0023/PR/2007;
- The amendments to several articles of the Labour Code, begun in 2010 and led by a National Technical Committee, took this concern into account;
- Articles 282 to 288 of the Criminal Code also contribute to the protection of persons with disabilities from discrimination;
- The increase in the family benefits provided by the social security system, through Decree No. 000604 of 2002, also applies to persons with disabilities;
- The procedures for punishing violations in the fields of labour, employment, occupational health and safety and social security cover persons with disabilities in accordance with Decree No. 000741 of 2005;
- The procedures for the care of patients in public health centres, including persons with disabilities, are set forth in Decree No. 104 of 2007;
- The establishment of a court welfare office, under Order No. 001 of 1972, also contributes to the State's guarantees of equal treatment for persons with disabilities;
- Act No. 07 of 1996 on Political Elections, which does not discriminate in this regard;
- Act No. 24 of 1996 on Political Parties, which does not differentiate between men and women in terms of their participation in public life.

11. In addition to the courts, Gabon has set up national mechanisms to deal with cases of discrimination, including the National Committee for the Integration of Persons with Disabilities and a National Technical Commission for Rehabilitation and Functional Therapy.[3] In addition, as regards labour law reform, a national committee responsible for reviewing the Labour Code has just released its conclusions pending collective agreements, expected in the near future.

12. Chapter 11 of the Criminal Code devotes six articles to attacks on the honour and reputation of individuals. Although they do not concern persons with disabilities alone, articles 283 to 288 nonetheless take into account any allegation or imputation of a fact that adversely affects the honour or reputation of the person, insulting expressions, terms of contempt or invective. The court may order penalties ranging from 6 months' to 2 years' imprisonment and fines of from €37 to €763. In addition, article 340 of the Criminal Code establishes what are referred to as category 1 penalties in respect of laws, decrees and orders relating to the rights of persons with disabilities; such penalties involve 1 to 5 days' imprisonment and a fine of from €0.15 to €3.00.

Women with disabilities (art. 6)

13. For the period 2005-2015, Gabon, in addition to other actions, committed to stepping up the pace of a set of measures favouring women and girls with or without disabilities. They included:

[3] Regulated by Decree No. 152 of 4 February 2002.

- Empowering women and girls with or without disabilities through increased productivity in the sectors in which they are active, notably agriculture, with a view to increasing their income;
- Improving access to production support services;
- Improving access to social services;
- Promoting equitable participation in the administration of government, respect for rights and the elimination of violence;
- Pursuing an active policy on HIV/AIDS and on prevention of cervical and breast cancer;[4]
- Supporting women's entrepreneurship and cooperatives through micro-loans;
- Completing the purge of articles that discriminate against women as part of the revision of the Civil Code and other legal instruments;
- Financing thousands of income-generating activities for low-income Gabonese women through the National Social Aid Fund, starting in September 2015.[5]

14. Involved in these efforts, in cooperative and inclusive fashion, are: l'Observatoire des droits de la femme et de la parité (the Observatory for Women's Rights and Parity); le Bureau pour la coordination des ONG féminines (the Office for the Coordination of Women's NGOs); le Réseau des femmes ministres et parlementaires (the Network of Women Ministers and Parliamentarians); le Comité national des femmes pour la paix et le développement (the National Committee of Women for Peace and Development); la Plate-forme des femmes pour le développement (the Women's Platform for Development); le Mouvement gabonais pour le bien-être familial (the Gabonese Family Welfare Movement); l'Association des femmes africaines face au sida (the Society for Women and AIDS in Africa); l'Association des femmes pour le développement de la solidarité et lutte contre les MST/VIH (the Association of Women for the Development of Solidarity and the Struggle against Sexually Transmitted Diseases/HIV); l'Association des filles-mères (the Association of Teenage Mothers); l'Association des femmes juristes du Gabon (the Gabon Women Lawyers' Association); l'Association des femmes commerçantes du Gabon (the Gabon Businesswomen's Association); l'Association des femmes éducatrices du Gabon (the Gabon Women Educators' Association); l'Association pour le progrès et la défense des droits des femmes (the Association for the Advancement and Defence of Women's Rights); le Centre des métiers de la femme (the Women's Vocational Centre); and le Réseau des femmes chefs d'entreprises du Gabon (the Network of Women Entrepreneurs of Gabon).

15. With regard to allowances for women and children with or without disabilities, several measures have been made a part of the "Gabon Investment in People" strategy. They include:

- Prenatal allowances paid on three occasions to all women, whether married or unemployed: €10 in the third month of pregnancy, €11.50 in the sixth month and €69 in vouchers for baby clothes in the eighth month;
- Cash transfers to single mothers, older persons and persons with disabilities;
- The grant for childbirth is €13;

[4] Strengthening voluntary screening campaigns, advocacy, information and education, provision of drugs for opportunistic infections, social marketing of condoms and treatment of sick women and girls, without distinction of any kind.

[5] Projects include sale of fresh food (fruits and vegetables), small restaurants, sewing workshops, office supplies, food shops, agriculture, trash collection and recycling, market gardens, etc.

- Family allowances paid until the age of 20 and amounting to €11 a month per child,[6] in addition to the payment of a back-to-school allowance of €69;
- Financial safety nets, in the form of direct assistance for access to minimum dietary, educational and sanitary conditions and full coverage of some goods and services;
- Solidarity income in rural areas through guaranteed minimum revenues.

16. Regarding provisions that discriminate against women, which also affect women with disabilities, developments of note include:

- A bill to set a quota of 30 per cent for female participation in elective offices, currently under review;
- The replacement of the family council by the inheritance council, comprising surviving spouses or their agents and the ascendants or their agents or representatives;
- The legal heirs are the descendants, the surviving spouse or spouses or orphans and the parents of the deceased;
- The case of ipso jure exclusion on account of unworthiness to inherit;
- The introduction of protective measures from the moment of death (prohibitions on evicting the surviving spouse or spouses or orphans from the family home, on carrying out acts of violence against them or dispossessing them and on opposing their presence or involvement in funeral arrangements);
- The introduction of measures to penalize violations of the law in the event of identity fraud and other judicial decisions;
- The bill amending provisions of the Social Security Code to remove discrimination against widows[7] and harmonize all social security systems;[8]
- The criminalization of incest and aggravated penalties for any sexual assault, in order to combat violence against women and girls;[9]
- The development, starting in 2015, of the Family and Social Action Code, with a view to a thorough revision of the discriminatory provisions;[10]
- The establishment of a national commission to reflect on the legalization of customary marriages, in order to reduce discrimination against women in such unions.

Children with disabilities (art. 7)

17. Health-care services are provided to persons with disabilities by the Government, as are health insurance and social protection. Persons with disabilities receive family allowances, and the National Health Insurance and Social Protection

[6] Currently applies to approximately 80,434 parents and 178,966 children, whose ages range from 0 to 20.

[7] In all, 12.9 per cent of persons with disabilities are widows.

[8] This bill redefines the survivor as the beneficiary of the survivor's pension (widow or widower), provided that the marriage was contracted at least one year prior to the death, unless a child was born of the union or the widow is pregnant at the time of death.

[9] Imprisonment for a term of 5 to 10 years and a fine of from €7,621 to €15,243.

[10] Marriage age, effects of customary and religious marriage.

Fund[11] bears the cost of medical evacuations to countries more advanced in the treatment of certain congenital disabilities.[12]

18. In recent years only, in addition to the National School for Hearing-impaired Children, the Fondation Horizons Nouveaux, the Centre Martin Luther King and two religious institutions, the Immaculée Conception School and Quaben school, have begun receiving children with disabilities to enable them to continue their studies at the secondary level. Moreover, the National Health and Social Work School, now the National Training Institute for Health Care and Social Work, trains special education instructors and educational social workers. The Fondation Nouveaux Horizons trains its staff of 60 persons. There is currently a national vulnerability scale used by persons responsible for social welfare, health and education. For example, a child with a disability who is not turning up for school, lives with a parent whose monthly income is €77, is exploited and has never seen a psychologist is assigned to level 2 on a scale of 1 to 3 and presents a combination of health, education, financial, protection and psychological problems.

19. In the area of employment, Act No. 19/95 encourages companies to hire persons with disabilities, but unfortunately it has not had the desired results. That does not mean, however, that persons with disabilities do not work, whether in the private sector or the Gabonese civil service.

20. The Government and 12 civil society organizations are working together to raise public awareness of the rights of children with disabilities. Since 2012, on the occasion of every Day of the African Child, Gabon has taken the opportunity to raise awareness of the rights of children in general, including the rights of children with disabilities.[13]

21. In Gabon, the opinions of children with or without disabilities are respected and taken into account. Children freely express their opinions on the violence they are subjected to; in school settings, school cooperatives and peer elections for class representatives are also examples of the expression of children's views. The Youth Parliament is another form of expression, as are voluntary organizations.

Awareness-raising (art. 8)

22. In addition to the points mentioned above, both the Directorate-General of Human Rights and the National Human Rights Commission, in partnership with the Centre for Human Rights and Democracy in Yaoundé, Cameroon, organized several seminars on the Convention on the Rights of the Child and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities for associations responsible for the promotion and protection of those rights, the media and the judiciary, among others.

Accessibility (art. 9)

23. In January 2010, the Government adopted a decree on the accessibility of public buildings for persons with disabilities. Following the example of work done on the entrances to such public and private buildings as the Senate, the Armed Forces Hospital, the main bakery Le Pelisson and the University Hospital of Libreville, other buildings built since have taken this concern into account, while yet others, such as the National Assembly, the Economic and Social Council, other ministries and

[11] CNAMGS.
[12] In 2010, the medical evacuations of 13 children with hydrocephalus were covered.
[13] 2010: national awareness-raising campaign in Libreville schools on the theme of persons with disabilities and their difficulties in school; 2012: national awareness-raising campaign on the protection of children living with disabilities.

universities, have redone their entrances to improve their accessibility to users with disabilities.

24. There is no discrimination against persons with disabilities as regards the risk of disasters. Disaster alerts are announced in different media, and on television a sign-language interpreter provides the necessary information. Persons with disabilities are not neglected in disaster situations.

Equal recognition before the law (art. 12)

25. There are no plans to repeal domestic laws to abolish substituted decision-making and guardianship regimes in Gabon, or to introduce supported decision-making for persons with psychosocial disabilities or other individuals with disabilities.

Liberty and security of the person (art. 14)

26. No one has been detained without consent in an institution as a result of his or her disability.

Access to justice (art. 13)

27. Equal treatment is ensured at all stages of proceedings, in line with Gabonese law and the international instruments to which Gabon is party. A lawyer is appointed by the court for a litigant who is unable to obtain one;[14] each provincial capital has a court, and mobile court hearings are held to provide local judicial services; legal aid is provided in civil, criminal and administrative matters, as well as in contentious and non-contentious matters, and even for protective acts or enforcement proceedings.[15] In accordance with Act No. 4/82 of 22 July 1982, income (insufficient) and residency conditions must be met to receive legal aid.

28. Since 2010, to improve access to justice, the Government has been committed to an overhaul of the institutional framework and the reform of some legislation, training to create a body of highly qualified personnel, reorganizing the judiciary and ensuring its independence, and amending the Act on the organization of the judicial system and the status of judges, which is no longer well-suited to the current context.

29. Sign-language interpreters may be used in the courts, if necessary.

30. In addition to the programmes offered at the Legal Service Training College, seminars for judicial personnel and the police are organized by the Attorney General and the Directorate-General of Human Rights, in partnership with the Centre for Human Rights and Democracy in Yaoundé.

Freedom from exploitation, violence and abuse (art. 16)

31. Exploitation, violence and abuse are prohibited by law. Articles 230 to 239 of the Criminal Code cover mutilation, amputation, blindness or other permanent harm inflicted on an adult or on a child under 15. Article 235, for example, prohibits deliberately depriving a child of food or care to the point of jeopardizing his or her

[14] Article 51 of the Code of Civil Procedure: “Beneficiaries are exempted from the payment of fees, which shall be advanced by the Treasury and authorized for payment out of criminal justice funds; they are entitled to the assistance, free of charge, of a process server and counsel. As of right, the aid covers enforcement measures and proceedings.”

[15] Article 50 of the Code of Civil Procedure: “Legal aid may be granted in any case to any litigants, when, as a result of their insufficient means, they are unable to exercise their legal rights, whether they are plaintiffs or defendants. It is available for all disputes and all non-contentious proceedings.”

health. The punishment for these offences ranges from a prison term of 2 months to life imprisonment, together with fines.

32. At the institutional level, the following services have been created: the Social Services for Education in Non-custodial Environments of the Ministry of Social Affairs; the Child Protection Services of the Ministry of the Interior; the Directorate-General of Human Rights; the National Human Rights Commission; the National Observatory for Children's Rights and four juvenile courts.

33. The training given to police officers, judges and health-care professionals focuses on the Convention on the Rights of the Child and the Convention on the Rights of Persons with Disabilities, in addition to the basic subjects related to each training programme. These courses are often designed as special seminars. Moreover, copies of the conventions are made available to those personnel, to help them better understand their provisions. In 2015, an agreement on the teaching of a human rights module was signed by the Directorate-General of Human Rights and the Legal Service Training College.[16] This initiative will continue in 2016 with the National Gendarmerie Academy and the National Police Academy.

Liberty of movement and nationality (art. 18)

34. A plan to establish a mechanism for coordinating information on birth registration, under the responsibility of the Ministry of the Interior, has been put forward by the Government. The objective of this mechanism is to have a central register of information related to birth registration. Currently, one of the main concerns of the Government is to have a genuine, reliable statistical database in this area, specifically with regard to vital records.[17] Consequently, we cannot as yet provide an estimate of the number of people with disabilities who were not registered at birth.

35. As noted in the report, persons with disabilities can move freely and choose their place of residence (see report).

Living independently and being included in the community (art. 19)

36. Persons with disabilities[18] participate in community life, albeit not enough. In addition to the points mentioned in the report, we include below data that could demonstrate the steadily increasing inclusion of persons with disabilities in the community:

- 8,734 cannot read or write, whereas 853 know only how to read, and 13,834 know how to read and write — 62.7 per cent of persons with disabilities above the age of 3 are literate, whereas 37.3 per cent are not;
- 51.9 per cent have a primary education; 27.2 per cent have a first-cycle secondary education and 8.6 per cent have a second-cycle secondary education; 5.2 per cent have a higher level of education;
- 51.4 per cent of persons with disabilities are involved in personal services, as employers of domestic workers; 19.4 per cent work in agriculture, animal husbandry, hunting and forestry; 13.6 per cent are in general administration, business, social services, the health sector and primary and secondary education.

[16] A postgraduate vocational institution.
[17] In 2011, an estimated 9,552 children a year were not given birth certificates.
[18] Around 24,000 in all.

Freedom of expression and access to information and communication (art. 21)

37. In addition to the information given in the report, persons with disabilities have access to the media in accessible and usable formats. Specialists ensure the use of sign language for all important information on television and in activities bringing together persons with disabilities.

Respect for home and the family (art. 23)

38. No specific measures have been taken to ensure that mothers of children with disabilities are not stigmatized; in any event, measures relating to women also apply to mothers of children with disabilities (see report).

Education (art. 24)

39. Every year, the National School for Hearing-impaired Children takes nearly 157 children of both sexes, from 3 years of age to 21, who are mentored by 73 members of staff, some of whom also have hearing impairments. The children are divided into 11 sections, by level.

40. (See paragraphs 17 to 21.)

Health (art. 25)

41. The following measures have been taken for persons with and without disabilities and are in effect:

- An increase of 150 per cent, from 1 billion to 2.5 billion CFA francs, in the Support Fund to Fight AIDS, for the purchase of antiretroviral drugs and preventive actions;
- Free antiretroviral treatment for anyone infected with HIV/AIDS living in Gabon, whereas in the past this was only for destitute persons;
- Free prenatal and obstetric care for all pregnant women living with HIV/AIDS;
- Free HIV/AIDS tests, laboratory analyses and treatment of opportunistic infections, with the cost covered by the National Health Insurance and Social Protection Fund;
- Treatment at hospitals, medical establishments and health centres for persons living with HIV/AIDS: in the past, treatment was available solely at outpatient facilities;
- Revitalization of AIDS prevention committees in each of the country's provinces and departments, under the supervision of the provincial governors;
- Intensification of HIV/AIDS awareness-raising campaigns for the overall population and target groups;
- Strengthening of the operational capacities of HIV/AIDS committees in every institution and ministry as well as in local governments and the private sector;
- Annual inclusion of funding to combat AIDS in the budget of each of the entities listed above;
- Inclusion of a module on HIV/AIDS prevention and sexual and reproductive health in the training curricula for teachers and trainers, and revitalization of AIDS and sexual and reproductive health information clubs at all schools and universities;

- Introduction of a social marketing strategy for condoms in order to make them accessible and available throughout the country, including in hotels and shops;
- Greater involvement of political leaders, public and private administrators, religious figures and heads of associations in raising public awareness of HIV/AIDS.

Habilitation and rehabilitation (art. 26)

42. The Commission on Habilitation and Rehabilitation acts as an advisory body to the Government on improving health-care services for persons with disabilities. It is made up of experts and of resource persons with disabilities and provides the Government with essential guidance.

Work and employment (art. 27)

43. In addition to articles 179 and 180, described above, the Labour Code includes the two following articles:

> Article 181: "Employers must set aside a share of jobs for persons with disabilities who have the relevant professional qualifications. This quota is set at one fortieth of the employer's total payroll. Any employers who employ 40 workers or more shall report annually to the labour inspector, in writing, the number of employees in their employ, the number of employees with disabilities in their employ and the particular disability of each of the latter."
>
> Article 182: "In the event of a layoff, employers shall do their utmost to preserve the jobs of workers with disabilities."

44. (See paragraph 36.)

Participation in cultural life, recreation, leisure and sport

45. The National Paralympic Federation receives subsidies from the Government to organize its activities. The State helps the Federation acquire equipment when necessary.

Participation in political and public life (art. 29)

46. In terms of the participation of persons with disabilities, there are no discriminatory provisions that limit their right to vote in Gabon. With or without disabilities, citizens have the same civil and political rights.

Special obligations

47. Some final statistical data:

- Gabon has about 27,000 persons with disabilities, or 2 per cent of the total population;
- Men account for approximately 54 per cent of all people with disabilities; adolescents for approximately 37 per cent and older persons for approximately 22 per cent;
- Some 35 per cent of persons with disabilities live in rural areas;
- There are 118 men with disabilities for every 100 women;

- 26 per cent of persons with disabilities are married,[19] and nearly 12 per cent are in de facto unions; approximately 46.5 per cent are single;
- The active population is approximately 8,000 people, including 5,000 men (61 per cent) and 3,060 women (30 per cent);
- The economically inactive population is made up of invalids (38 per cent), students (35 per cent) and other inactive persons (33 per cent);
- Some 65 per cent of persons with disabilities live in urban areas.

[19] Disability is not an impediment in Gabon.